

SEO and Metadata Differences with PWA Kit

PWA Kit uses react-helmet to manage meta tags, with developers manually adding Helmet components to each page. Storefront Next provides a comprehensive SEO system built around the `SeoMeta` component, with built-in support for hreflang alternates, canonical URLs, Open Graph, Twitter Cards, and robots control. Both support dynamic metadata, but Storefront Next offers a more complete, production-ready SEO implementation out of the box.

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Key Differences

Aspect	PWA Kit	Storefront Next
Library	react-helmet	Built-in React component (<code>SeoMeta</code>)
Pattern	Manual Helmet in each page	<code>SeoMeta</code> component
Dynamic Meta	Implemented via Helmet	Implemented via <code>SeoMeta</code>
Hreflang	Not documented	Automatic locale alternates
Canonical URLs	Not documented	With query param normalization
Robots Control	Manual via Helmet	Built-in <code>noIndex</code> prop
Social Tags	Manual via Helmet	Open Graph + Twitter Card support
API Integration	Consumes <code>pageMetaTags</code>	Uses <code>SeoMeta</code> with dynamic props

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```
1 // Per-page Helmet usage
2 import { Helmet } from "react-helmet";
3
4 export default function ProductDetail() {
5   return (
6     <>
7       <Helmet>
8         <title>{product.pageTitle}</title>
9         <meta name="description" content={pro
10       </Helmet>
11       {/* page content */}
12     </>
13   );
14 }
```

Storefront Next:

```
1 // SeoMeta component usage
2 import { SeoMeta } from "@components/seo-met
3
4 export default function ProductDetail() {
5   return (
6     <>
7       <SeoMeta
8         title={product.pageTitle}
9         description={product.pageDescription}
10        openGraph={{
11          type: "product",
12          url: canonicalUrl,
13          image: product.imageUrl,
14        }}
15      />
16      {/* page content */}
17    </>
18  );
19 }
```

API Meta Tag Consumption

PWA Kit consumes the Commerce API's
`pageMetaTags` array directly:

```
1 // PWA Kit: Renders each meta tag from API vi
2 import { Helmet } from "react-helmet";
3
4 <Helmet>
5   <title>{product.pageTitle}</title>
6   <meta name="description" content={product.p
7   {product.pageMetaTags?.map(({ id, value })
8     <meta name={id} content={value} key={id}
```



explicit prop names when consuming pageMetaTags directly:

```
1 // Storefront Next: Uses SeoMeta component
2 import { SeoMeta } from "@components/seo-meta"
3
4 <SeoMeta
5   title={product.pageTitle}
6   description={product.pageDescription}
7   openGraph={{
8     type: "product",
9     url: canonicalUrl,
10    image: product.imageUrl,
11  }}
12   twitter={{ cardType: "summary_large_image"
13 />
```

If you need to consume `pageMetaTags` in Storefront Next, you can map them to the `SeoMeta` props or render them as additional meta tags.

Key Similarities

1. **Dynamic metadata:** Both support dynamic page titles and meta descriptions.
2. **SSR support:** Both render meta tags server-side for SEO.
3. **Component-based:** Both use React components to manage meta tags.
4. **No structured data:** Neither implements JSON-LD by default (can be added manually).

Storefront Next Advantages

1. **Hreflang alternates:** Automatically generates locale-specific alternate links with x-default support.
2. **Canonical URLs:** Built-in canonical URL generation with query parameter normalization and allowlist.
3. **Social tags:** Built-in Open Graph and Twitter Card support via `SeoMeta` props.
4. **Robots control:** Simple `noIndex` prop for controlling search engine indexing.
5. **Centralized SEO utils:** SEO logic consolidated in `src/utils/seo.ts` and `src/utils/canonical-url.ts`.
6. **Title modes:** Support for suffixed (default), raw, and fallback title rendering.



for all supported locales:

```
1 <!-- Automatically generated in <head> -->
2 <link rel="canonical" href="https://www.examp
3 <link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-GB" href="
4 <link rel="alternate" hreflang="fr-FR" href="
5 <link
6   rel="alternate"
7   hreflang="x-default"
8   href="https://www.example.com/global/en-GB/
9 />
```

PWA Kit does not provide built-in hreflang support. You would need to implement this manually using react-helmet.

Canonical URL Management

Storefront Next includes sophisticated canonical URL handling with query parameter normalization:

Allowed parameters (kept in canonical URL):

- `q` - search query
- `offset` - pagination
- `sort` - sort order
- `refine` - filters
- `pid` - product variant ID

Removed parameters: All tracking params, analytics IDs, and non-content parameters are stripped.

PWA Kit does not provide built-in canonical URL management. You would need to implement this manually.

Storefront Conversion Considerations

When migrating from PWA Kit to Storefront Next:

1. Replace react-helmet with SeoMeta
 - Remove `react-helmet` imports and `<Helmet>` components.
 - Replace with `<SeoMeta>` component from `@/components/seo-meta`.
 - Convert inline meta tags to `SeoMeta` props.
2. Leverage Built-in SEO Features
 - Hreflang alternates are already configured in `src/utls/seo.ts`.

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3. Add noIndex for Protected Pages

- Use `<SeoMeta noIndex />` for account, checkout, and order pages.
- This prevents search engines from indexing private content.

4. Configure Query Parameters

- Update `CONTENT_PARAMS` in `src/Utils/canonical-url.ts` if you add custom query params that affect page content.

5. Optional: Add Structured Data

- Consider adding JSON-LD for products, categories, and breadcrumbs.
- Render `<script type="application/ld+json">` tags within route components.

6. Test Multi-Locale Sites

- Verify hreflang links are generated correctly for all locales.
- Confirm canonical URLs strip locale prefixes appropriately.

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